MODULE-4 · MASTERCLASS DOSSIER

4.3 The 3 Touch Follow Up System

Lesson masterclass · implementation drills · war-room directive

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- Run a value-then-grace three-touch escalation.
- Land touch-3 on a fresh board after the station’s music meeting.
- Ask for rotation upgrades (light → medium) at week four.

★ **INSIDER RADIO TIP**

Rotation upgrades are the real follow-up. Four weeks after an add, ask for the light→medium upgrade with receipts. Almost no independent makes that ask — that’s exactly why it works.

▲ **THE OPERATOR MOVE**

Time the upgrade ask to land right after the station’s weekly music meeting — Thursday afternoon, not Monday morning.

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4.3 The 3-Touch Follow-Up System — Persistence Without the Stench

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THE ONE-LINE TRUTH: The first email is a knock on the door. The second is proof you are serious. The third is a dignified exit. Over 65% of all independent radio adds occur on Touch 2 and Touch 3.

MASTERCLASS DIRECTIVE & STRATEGIC BLUEPRINT

Strategic Foundation & Operational Reality

Amateurs view follow-up emails as awkward, intrusive begging. They wait two weeks, feel guilty, and eventually send a cringe-inducing message: “Just bumping this to the top of your inbox!” or “Did you get a chance to listen to my single yet?”

This language communicates zero value, demands emotional labor from the programmer, and creates instant resentment.

Dominion operators know that **programmers rely on follow-ups to filter out the tourists**. A music director receives 500 pitches a week; they intentionally ignore cold first-time emails to see which artists actually possess an organized campaign system and which ones disappear forever after one try.

The **3-Touch Follow-Up System** is a disciplined, multi-stage value escalation cadence. It never bumps. It never asks if they listened. Every single touch introduces a **brand-new, high-value commercial asset or proof receipt**.

The Strict 3-Touch Cadence & Asset Escalation Architecture

- **Touch 1 (Day 1 / Day 3 — The Initial Payload):** The complete 90-word pitch, 3-layer subject line, proof stack, and private streaming link. Sets the commercial baseline.
- **Touch 2 (Day 8 to Day 10 — The Value Drop):** Dispatched 7 to 8 days after Touch 1. Keeps the original email thread intact so the programmer sees context. Delivers a brand-new asset that lowers listening friction:
- Copy Structure (Under 45 Words): “Hi [Name] — in case it’s quicker during your music meeting, here’s a 30-second direct hook stream: [Link]. Also confirmed upcoming [Hometown Club] showcase on [Date]. Would love to see this in rotation for [Show Name].”
- Asset Introduced: The 30-Second Sweeper Hook or 90-Second Audio Weapon, plus a newly confirmed tour date or press quote.
- **Touch 3 (Day 14 to Day 16 — The Dignified Exit & Final Proof Point):** Dispatched 6 to 7 days after Touch 2. Cites new momentum and provides a clean, respectful off-ramp:
- Copy Structure (Under 50 Words): “Hi [Name] — quick update: [Song Title] was just added into rotation at [Station A] and [Station B] this week. If it’s not a fit for [Station Callsign] right now, no problem at all — we’ll reconnect on the next release cycle. Keep up the great programming.”

The Iron Law of the Exit: Stop at Three

If Touch 3 produces no response, **the campaign is closed**. You do not send a fourth email. You do not send a passive-aggressive message. You log the contact as ‘Cold / 90-Day Hold’ and exit with total dignity. You have established yourself as a courteous, professional operator who respects their boundaries. When you return with your next single in 90 days, your email will be greeted with respect.

IMPLEMENTATION DRILLS & PASS STANDARDS

- **Drill 1 — Touch 2 & Touch 3 Script Pre-Drafting (25 min).** Draft customized Touch 2 and Touch 3 templates for your top 5 War Room stations using the Follow-Up Cockpit below. Ensure each touch carries a distinct, verifiable proof asset.
- **Drill 2 — The Bumping Language Scrub (15 min).** Search your drafts for the words ‘bump’, ‘checking in’, ‘following up’, ‘wondering if’. Permanently delete them and replace with new asset delivery statements.
- **Drill 3 — Calendar Follow-Up Scheduling (15 min).** Set exact calendar reminders for Day 8 (Touch 2) and Day 15 (Touch 3) for all 20 War Room targets.
- **Drill 4 — The Dignified Exit Mental Rehearsal (10 min).** Read the Touch 3 script aloud. Practice the emotional discipline of accepting non-engagement without resentment.

ACTION WORKSHEET & OPERATIONAL PROTOCOL

Protocol Document: `3-TOUCH FOLLOW-UP COCKPIT & VALUE ESCALATION LOG`

Complete the structured table below as part of your lesson implementation. This worksheet directly replaces legacy spreadsheets with a publication-grade execution protocol.

Target Station	Touch 1 Dispatch Date	Touch 2 Date & Asset Delivered	Touch 3 Date & Proof Point	Response / Final Status	Next Cycle Action
WLUW 88.7 FM	Day 1 (Tuesday)	Day 8: 30s Hook Clip + Metro Date	Day 15: Added at WNUR & WMSE	CONFIRMED ADD (Day 16)	Initiate Thank-You Loop

WNUR 89.3 FM	Day 1 (Tuesday)	Day 8: Unreleased Acoustic Cut	N/A (Replied on Touch 2)	CONFIRMED ADD (Day 9)	Initiate Thank-You Loop
WMSE 91.7 FM	Day 1 (Tuesday)	Day 8: Milwaukee Tour Date Pass	Day 15: Regional Press Quote	CONFIRMED ADD (Day 15)	Initiate Thank-You Loop
WXPN 88.5 FM	Day 3 (Thursday)	Day 10: 90s Audio Weapon	Day 17: NACC Chart Debut	Declined (Polite Exit)	Log to 90-Day Archive
KUTX 98.9 FM	Day 3 (Thursday)	Day 10: Live Video Clip	Day 17: Austin Club Date	No Reply (Closed)	Log to 90-Day Archive

WAR-ROOM NOTES

WAR-ROOM DIRECTIVE — 4.3 The 3-Touch Follow-Up System — Persistence Without the Stench

WHY THREADING YOUR REPLIES IS A NON-NEGOTIABLE LAW

When dispatching Touch 2 and Touch 3, **always reply directly to the sent message thread of Touch 1**.

- Do NOT generate a brand new email with a new subject line.
- When the programmer opens Touch 2, they must be able to scroll down and immediately see your original 90-word pitch, original proof lines, and contact information.
- Threading proves continuity. It shows the programmer that you have a deliberate, multi-week campaign architecture rather than sporadic, disorganized thoughts.

FREQUENCY DOMINION COMMUNITY DRILLS

1. Post your tailored Touch 2 copy for peer review. Check that it delivers a fresh asset under 45 words.
2. Share a historical win where a follow-up email secured an add after the initial pitch was ignored.
3. Affirm your commitment to the ‘Stop at Three’ law in the community discussion.
4. Report your conversion rate from Touch 2 and Touch 3 across your active campaigns.

Key Takeaways

REMEMBER THIS

- Value first, then grace.
- Rotation upgrades are the real follow-up.
- Light → medium is the most winnable ask in radio.

Self-Assessment · Check Your Mastery

PASS BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- 1. Are my three touches spaced, escalated, and polite?
- 2. Is touch-3 timed to land after the station’s music meeting?
- 3. Have I planned a week-4 rotation-upgrade ask with receipts?